

GENDER

Savita Bamne Vs. Alankar Kadam



We're a little addicted to StumbleUpon here at *Digit*, so we thought of bending the genders around that general theme: use StumbleUpon to stumble upon various sites, pick one you like most, and tell us why you like it. In addition, we allowed Savita and Alankar to select site categories before Stumbling.

BENDERS

Creating an account took up some of Savita's time; she took even longer to select her site preferences. Cats turned out to be her first love; for categories, she selected Animation, Clothing, Graphic Design, Movies, Photographs, Arts, Books, and Multimedia. Swcp.com was her first site, and she took an instant liking to it. We didn't. (The site hosts



cat pics.) Some more clicking took her to tinyvices.com—hundreds of paintings and photos—fascinating! For Savita, that is. After musicrecovery.com and changer.com, she stopped at petebevin.com. You guessed it—lots of (ugh) cat photos!



A man with varied interests in life, Alankar selected Animation, Graphic Design, Photography, Books, Travel, Clothing, Cats (yes!), Web Development, Music, Movies, Animals, and Multimedia. We were happy he stopped his preference-choosing at this point! His first site—outdoor-photos.com—had some breathtaking landscape photos. A few clicks later, he stumbled upon typenow.net and nerdyshirts.com, and finally, it was bustedtees.com for Alankar. This site has some cool T-shirt logos and text, and is well-designed. T-shirts or cats—take your pick!



a little further, to try and compete with Microsoft's Xbox 360 and Nintendo's Wii. Apart from the advantage of having launched earlier, the Xbox 360 and Wii are significantly cheaper, while the Xbox 360 is completely compatible with older Xbox games.

Another change in the newer PS3s will be the shift from the now-famous Cell processor's current 90 nm manufacturing to the smaller and cheaper 65 nm process.

All this cost cutting was probably because Sony recently announced that it

would be losing a lot more money than it had thought on each PS3 sold. Strange though it sounds, Sony always expected losses on the PS3, hoping to make up the differences in terms of game sales. Microsoft and Nintendo follow the same business strategy. Cheaper parts and technologies translate to lower costs for Sony's competitors, and as a result, the Nintendo Wii costs about half as much as Sony's PS3. Interestingly, the Wii is still the top-selling gaming console, beating both the Xbox and Ps3 in terms of numbers sold in 2007!

MORE GAMING NEWS

Microsoft Open Live Service To PC Gamers

What was always a privilege for Xbox 360 owners is all set to be a globally available, cross-platform gaming service. The Live service will be opened to PC gamers in the first half of May 2007, providing you're gaming on Vista, that is. Windows XP users can put that bottle of champagne away, because you're going to have to cough up anywhere between 10 and 20K to get some flavour of Vista before you can subscribe to the Live service.

To help build excitement, Microsoft is in preparations to launch *Halo 2* for Windows Vista, which should get a few million gamers excited. However, the PC version will differ from the Xbox 360 version, so don't expect to be playing against your Xbox 360 buddy using your PC. For that kind of interoperability, you're going to have to wait for Microsoft's next game, *Shadowrun*, which is expected to be released in mid-2007.

Another good thing is that those with Live memberships will need just one account ID to play on either PC or Xbox 360. In order to be able to play

against an Xbox 360 owner using your PC, you will have no choice but to buy a Gold membership for \$50 (Rs 2,250) per year, which isn't that bad.

ANOTHER LAWSUIT

Will YouTube Die A Viacom Death?

For those who haven't heard already: Google is being sued by US cable TV company Viacom. The lawsuit complains about clips of TV shows being shown on YouTube, which Viacom holds copyrights to. Some of said shows include the hit adult cartoon *South Park* and other Comedy Central hits such as *The Daily Show* and *The Colbert Report*.

The lawsuit reportedly asks for a billion dollars (Rs 4,500 crore) in damages, and demands that YouTube put up a proper filtering technique to prevent further copyright infringements.

Thus far, YouTube has protected itself by citing the Digital Millennium Copyright Act of 1998, which basically protects service providers such as ISPs from being sued for the wrongdoing of their customers. So, if you hack into the US pentagon, you can be jailed, but your ISP cannot be penalised. The same goes for hosting copyrighted content, if you host pirated content, on

IPN (InterPlaNet)

IPN is to be used for deep-space data communications between Earth, Mars, and other planets. The project, funded by NASA in collaboration with DARPA, is supporting a team of scientists at the Jet Propulsion Laboratory in Houston, Texas. The objective behind the IPN project is to build an architecture for a future inter-planetary Internet by setting nodes across the solar system for connecting the Internet on Earth with the internet of other planets and spacecraft. The basic

components of IPN are NASA's Deep Space Network (an international network of antennas to continuously track data and control navigation of spacecrafts), a six micro-satellite constellation around Mars, and the appropriate protocols. Challenges facing IPN include reducing delay in data transmission, figuring out the protocols, satellite maintenance, availability of domain names, and security from hackers. A link to Mars is planned by 2008.

Buzzword
of the MONTH